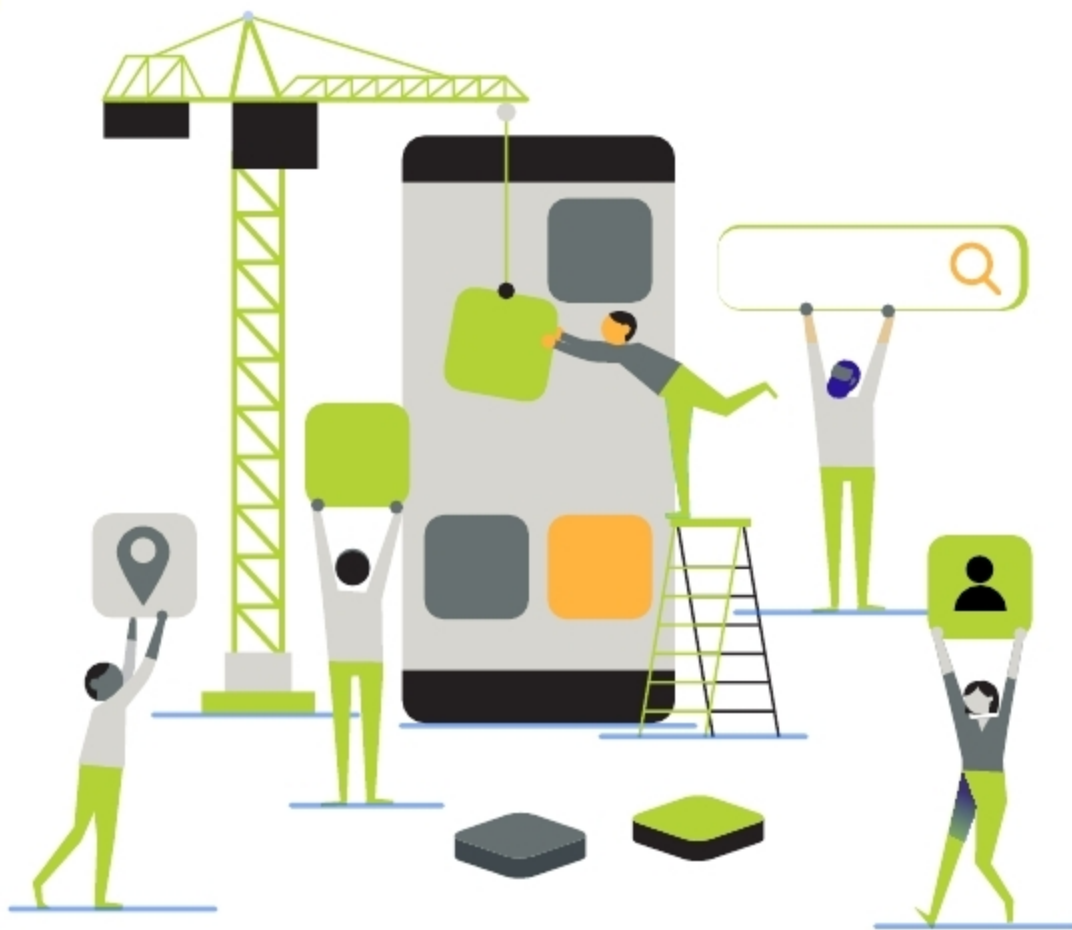


The Ultimate Guide to Becoming a Mobile App Developer

Becoming a mobile app developer is a very attractive proposition as professions go. If you have harboured similar dreams, then this article is meant for you. Remember, dreams have a way of becoming reality.



Any app means business. While mobile apps may have been traditionally associated with general productivity and information retrieval, business apps are now essential for many everyday operations. This is mainly because of the easy availability of smartphones and the BYOD (bring your own device) work policies with MDM (mobile device management) solutions in place. This means that employees can now use their Android smartphones or iPhones for general business processes, covering everything from productivity apps to collaborative software apps.

In 2020, mobile apps are projected to generate US\$ 188.9 billion in revenue via app stores and in-app advertising. According to a region-specific revenue projection, in 2022, consumers in USA are projected to spend over US\$ 34 billion through mobile apps via app stores. In addition, enterprise mobility is estimated to be worth US\$ 510.4 billion by 2022. In recent times, it has been observed that mobile Internet access has overtaken desktop Internet usage in a big way. In 2018, more than 70 per cent of the Web traffic originated from mobile devices, which was 57 per cent in 2017. In a recent survey, American adults are now spending over three hours every day on their mobiles, browsing the Internet, as compared to only two hours on a desktop computer.

Considering the popularity of smartphones and the increasing number of mobile apps, being a mobile app developer has never been so lucrative. Mobile app development involves apps being developed for mobile devices like PDAs, smartphones or other portable devices. These applications can be pre-installed on phones during the manufacturing process or delivered as Web applications using server-side or client-side processing like JavaScript to provide an 'application-like' experience within a Web browser. The most important aspect of app development is the design of the mobile user interface (UI). Designing the mobile UI involves following guidelines about certain constraints, contexts, the screen, input and mobility. The interface is made up of both hardware and software components.

Mobile UI contexts signal cues from user activity, such as the location and scheduling that can be gauged from user interactions within a mobile app. Overall, the goal of a mobile UI design is mainly an understandable, user-friendly interface. The UI of mobile apps should consider users' limited attention span, minimise keystrokes and be task-oriented with a minimum set of functions. This functionality is supported by mobile enterprise application platforms or integrated development environments (IDEs).